EXPLAINATION OF FLAG OFFICER CRITERIA

Below is a brief explanation of the criteria used by DoD to validate flag officer positions. These criteria are grouped into three main categories - Nature of the position, Magnitude of the Responsibilities, and Significance of Actions and Decisions. These categories are broad in nature to provide latitude in justifying the manpower requirement. Some manpower requirements may involve all these criteria to a certain extent, but most manpower requirements will probably be justified in terms of only the most significant duties.

A. NATURE OF THE POSITION

1. Characteristics of Function. Type (e.g., command, general or coordinating staff, special staff, manager, deputy, specialist, etc.,); Scope (e.g., operational command, training command, installation command, personnel management, officer personnel management, legal affairs, information, etc.); and Level of Function (e.g., national, secretarial, service, theater, field command, etc.).

2. Grade and Position of. Superior, principal subordinates, and lateral points of coordination; a consideration of the military or governmental structure within which the manpower requirement function is performed; and a statement of the level at which the function is performed.

3. Supervision over Position. The proximity (remoteness or closeness of supervision and the degree of independence of operation.

4. Official Relations with U.S. and Foreign Governmental Officials and with the Public. Nature (e.g., reports to, works for, keeps informed, provides liaison, etc.); extent (e.g., primary function, frequent requirement, continuous additional duty, occasional requirement, etc.); and level of official relations with U.S. and foreign governmental officials and with the public (e.g., governmental department or agency, national or local government, civil organizations, industry, press, etc.).

5. Reflection of National Emphasis and Determination. Relation of position to national objectives and programs, special conditions under which the position was first established or other reasons why the position reflects national will.

6. Special Qualifications Required by the Position. Any special qualifications such as advanced education, or particular training or experience, which are essential to the proper execution of positional responsibilities.

B. MAGNITUDE OF RESPONSIBILITIES

1. Missions of Organization and Special Requirements of the Position. The nature of the responsibilities that are associated with the position.

2. Number, Type, and Value of Resources Managed and Employed. Data should be displayed within three categories: operational control, administrative control, and immediate staff within each subsection.

(a) Military Forces. Number and type of forces normally assigned or programmed for planned or special operations.

(b) Personnel. Number of personnel (by officer and CWO, enlisted, and civilian).

(c) Value of Equipment and Properties (display in millions). Total value of equipment, supplies and real property.

(d) Total Obligational Authority & Foreign Resources. Scope and type of foreign resources involved, if any, or other important resources.

3. Geographical Area of Responsibilities. A consideration of the size, location and, if appropriate, the criticality of the land, sea, or air spaces involved.

4. Authority to make Decisions and Commit Resources. An identification of the scope of the position with respect to specific authority delegated to or withheld from the position in either routine or emergency situations.